

James Gosling

James Gosling came up with Java, while working for Sun, which was brought over by Oracle. He still develops the NetBeans IDE

jMonkeyEngine

Looking for a Java environment with advanced graphics support? jMoney is your answer

fixes version conflicts. You can add proper dependency exclusions to the project pom.xml using the Exclude context-menu on an artifact.

Swing GUI Builder

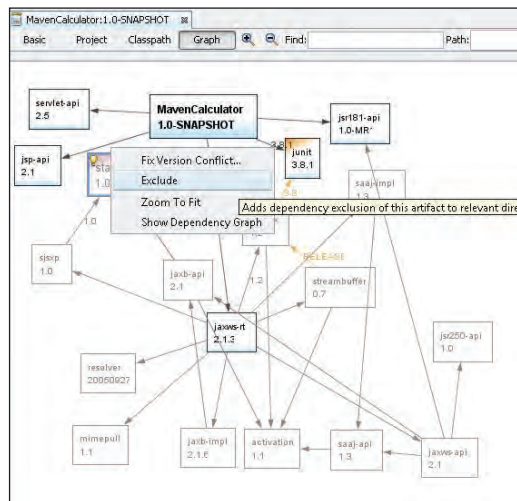
You can create professional looking GUIs by dragging and positioning GUI components from a palette onto a canvas. The builder automatically takes care of the correct spacing and alignment. Click into JLabels, JTrees, JTextFields, JButtons, ComboBoxes, ButtonGroups to edit their properties directly in place. This is much easier than the tedious process of creating your own visual Java editor from scratch.

With NetBeans you can choose whether the GUI code should be generated with fully qualified or simple class names. The helpbar displays context-sensitive hints about what can be done with the selected component and suggests shortcuts that can speed up your work considerably. The NetBeans IDE also comes with built-in support for GUI localization and accessibility.

Profiler

A profiler's job is to assist in optimization and tweaking of your application for increased efficiency, and NetBeans Profiler does that, and does it right. You can have task based profiling where you can select from several common profiling tasks, such as standard memory or CPU profiling, or simple monitoring. The options have been preset to default values but you can customize settings for a specific application. You precisely control the amount of overhead the profiler imposes, and therefore analyse the application while it runs at almost full speed. You can store analysis data for offline processing; Save and export snapshots of collected results as CSV, HTML, or XML files.

You can use NetBeans' Heap Walker to evaluate Java heap contents and to identify unnecessary references that cause memory leaks. You can browse classes and instances of classes on the heap, fields



Database view

of each instance or class, and references to each instance. You can also use jHat compatible OQL queries to analyse the contents of a heapdump.

For more precise control of the collection of profiling results, you can place profiling points in your source code (works similar to debugger breakpoints). You can then use these points to automatically trigger actions when certain conditions are met, such as execution of a line of code, time elapsed, or memory used. Profiling points can trigger heap dumps, the resetting of results collected, the running of a load generator script, and the taking of a results snapshot.

The NetBeans profiler can be set up to report only on particular methods or the entire application. A graph categorizes where CPU time has been spent. Clicking on the graph sections drills down from high-level categories to more detailed profiling information. You can profile an entire application, or a subset, under a realistic workload. This way you can identify the CPU bottlenecks in your application.

Profiler's Thread Timeline displays the current and past status of all threads in an application. Thread Details give you detailed information about one or more selected threads, including a list of all state changes in the thread life.

NetBeans Profiler also supports remote profiling, where the profiler can profile

an application that is running on a different system than your NetBeans IDE. The profiler's remote pack can be installed on a remote system, allowing you to profile an application that is started on that system.

Debugger

The modular structure of NetBeans enables easy plugin development, and sure enough there are hundreds of plugins available online. I am listing here some of the plugins which increased by work efficiency and general made my life easier.

iReport: is a visual report designer for JasperReports. You can manage charts, images, sub reports and crosstabs. Data can be retrieved using JDBC, Table Models, JavaBeans, XML, Hibernate, CSV...It supports PDF,RTF,XLS,CSV,HTML.

JVi: is a vi/vim editor clone. A must for vim lovers. Increases efficiency considerable if you have used vim before.

Visual Web Page Layouts: It installs sets of predefined Page Layouts based on Project Woodstock Components and their resources. Page authors can create initial pages for their Visual Web JSF Application using these page layouts. Currently NetBeans Visual Web application lack any page layout presets.

OpenSwing: is an open-source suite of advanced graphics components based on Swing toolkit that can be manipulated directly inside the UI designer of NetBeans. It is also a framework that provides data binding mechanism between components and data model, based on the MVC paradigm. Data model is based on Java Beans (POJOs) and it is supported in all OpenSwing components, such as Grid control or components container.

JDateChooser: DateChooser is a JavaBeans library for date selection. It contains 3 datepicker components: the panel, combo editor and a dialog window. You can use then directly in your GUI to select a single or a range of dates.

All of these plugins can be downloaded from <http://plugins.netbeans.org>. As a thumb rule most of them work with NetBeans V6 or higher and the latest java SDK. 

